Software Project Planning Guide

A practical checklist for planning projects that finish on time.

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(Starter edition - replace with the final branded guide.)

1. Define the goal

- What business outcome must this project deliver?
- Who are the users and what problem are we solving?
- How will we measure success (leads, revenue, time saved)?
- What is explicitly out of scope for version 1?

2. Plan scope and budget

- List features as user stories and rank them: must / should / could.
- Identify every third-party integration (payments, CRM, email).
- Agree a budget range and a contingency (10-20%).
- Decide who approves work and how quickly.

3. Choose team and technology

- Match the stack to the product, team skills and hosting budget.
- Decide build vs buy for each component.
- Plan design, development, QA and DevOps responsibilities.
- Confirm ownership of code, accounts and content.

4. Milestones and launch

- Break delivery into 2-week milestones with demos.
- Track risks weekly and keep a decision log.
- Launch checklist: performance, SEO, security, backups, analytics.
- Plan post-launch support and a 90-day growth roadmap.